

PYTHON & WINDOWS

Unlike most Unix platforms and systems, Windows does not come preloaded with a system supporting the installation of Python. In order to make Python available, the CPython team has compiled MSI packages or Windows Installers with every release for a while. The primary job of these installers is to add a per-user installation of Python, along with the core interpreter and library being used by a single user. The installer will also be capable of installing for every user on a single machine, as well as provide a separate ZIP file for application-local distributions.

Supported versions

PEP 11 clearly states that a Python release only supports a Windows platform while Microsoft considers the platform as being under extended support. What this means is that the latest Python release (3.7 in this case) supports Windows Vista and newer platforms.

Steps to install Python on Windows

There are four Python 3.7 installers that are available for download - two each for the 32 bit as well as 64 bit versions of the interpreter. The web installer is a small initial download which will automatically download the required components. The offline installer will include the components that are necessary for a default installation and will only require you to be connected to the internet when you are looking at optional features.

Given that some of the features of Python are not included in the initial installer download, you may need an active internet connection to select those features. In order to avoid this need, you can download all the possible components on-demand in order to create a complete layout that will not require an internet connection regardless of the selected features. This download may definitely be bigger than required, but when it comes to a situation where a larger number of installations are being performed it does definitely help to have locally cached copies.

Execute the following command from the Command Prompt in order to download all possible required files. While doing so, remember to substitute *python-3.7.0.exe* for the actual name of your installer. You should also create layouts in their own directories so as to avoid collisions between files carrying the same names. You may also specify the */quiet* option if you are looking to hide the progress display. You do not need to be an administrator. Python will directly be installed into your user directory. The only